

Section B: Historical Topics

Six topics are set: candidates are required to study **one**.

1. Song

2. Programme Music

3. Music for Screen

4. Music and Belief

5. Music for the Stage

6. Popular Music

Three questions will be set on each topic, of which candidates are required to answer **two**.

Candidates should be able to demonstrate:

- close familiarity with the prescribed repertoire of the chosen topic;
- an understanding of the characteristic techniques found in the topic and shown in the prescribed repertoire; and
- knowledge of the cultural and social context surrounding the prescribed repertoire through familiarity with related repertoire.

All questions will be marked out of 25.

Scores, recordings, films or other source material may not be taken into the examination.

The quality of written communication is assessed in this section of the question paper.

50 marks

Unit Content

Through close study of music for both sections of the question paper, candidates should develop their knowledge and understanding of the two Areas of Study, **Tonality** and **Interpretation**.

They should become familiar with the expressive features found in music that interprets text or other stimulus, and with the ways in which this interpretation can create dramatic tension, characterisation, mood or feeling as appropriate to the genre.

Candidates should also study the expressive use of tonality in response to words or other stimuli.

Section A: Aural Extract

From their study of a wide range of techniques, styles and genres in accompanied vocal music composed between 1900 and 1945, candidates will learn to identify and explain:

- the composer's interpretation of the text, through techniques of word setting;
- the expressive use of tonality in this interpretation;
- the contribution of the accompaniment to the interpretation; and
- features of interpretation in the performance.

They will also be expected to compare stylistic features of the extract with other music from the repertoire that they know.

The music chosen for this section will cover a wide range of genres and vocal forces. Candidates should become familiar with a range of musical language used in the period, including tonal and non-tonal styles.

Section B: Historical Topics

The topics and their prescribed repertoire offer many opportunities to make links with **Unit G355: Composing 2**.

- Topics 1, 2 and 3 are directly relevant to each of the three composition options in **Section B**.
- Several pieces in the prescribed repertoire offer models for study in relation to specific Stylistic Techniques options in **Section A**.

Each topic explores a genre or theme through the study of three prescribed works and related repertoire. In each group the three prescribed works are listed chronologically, and the dates of their composition, publication, first performance or release given, to ensure correct identification.

A continuous, developmental 'history of the genre' is **not** required. Each prescribed work offers a snapshot of its own time and place. A sufficiently broad range of related repertoire should also be studied, although in less depth, to illustrate the musical context of each prescribed work, and candidates should be given the opportunity to develop a full understanding of the social and cultural context of each one.

Prescribed Repertoire

Any scholarly edition of the prescribed repertoire may be used for study. In **Topic 3: Music for the Screen**, it is essential that the film itself is used for study rather than the score or recordings of 'concert' versions of the film scores.

Complete works are given. However, analysis of these entire works is not required. Candidates should undertake close study of individual numbers, movements or extended passages to gain insight into a range of techniques used in the interpretation of text, dialogue, action or other stimuli.

Candidates should become sufficiently familiar with the prescribed works to be able to locate from memory and refer to specific details in answer to questions in the examination. They should develop a secure sense of time and place, and an understanding of the significant factors that affected what music the composer produced and how (s)he worked.

Centres should select related repertoire to support and expand upon the three prescribed works in each genre.

The focus of enquiry into the music itself will be shaped by the two Areas of Study: **Tonality** and **Interpretation**.

Tonality

Each of the topics presents different opportunities for the study of typical features found in the development of tonality and alternative compositional styles. Together these build on the foundation of understanding mainstream Western tonality that was laid down at AS Level. Candidates should become confident in identifying a much wider range of chords and key relationships and learn to recognise how composers use these, and non-tonal language, for expressive purposes. Understanding certain styles in this way requires the development of relevant analytical techniques: 'formal' analysis for its own sake, however, is not required.

Interpretation

The topics and the prescribed repertoire illustrate ways in which composers have responded to a stimulus, most often a text or visual image. Relevant techniques should be understood, such as word-setting and the *rôle* of accompaniment, or the transformation of themes in orchestral music. Candidates should develop the ability to explain and illustrate in detail how they are used, and to evaluate their effectiveness.

Candidates are required to study **one** of the following topics:

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